Data Analyst Career Roadmaps: Comparison

Comparison of three 12-week roadmaps for developing beginner Data Analyst skills | Prepared 14 October 2026

Dimension	A: Data Analyst Learning Roadmap	B: Junior Data Analyst Roadmap	C: Untitled roadmap (AI Roadmap Generator)
Target learner	Complete beginner, basic computer skills, prefers free resources	Complete beginner, about 6 hrs/week	Beginner, 5–7 hrs/week
Total time	60–84 hrs (5–7 hrs every week)	About 72 hrs (6–7 hrs/week)	About 5–7 hrs/week (5–6 or 6–7 per week)
Spreadsheets	Weeks 1–2, Excel or Google Sheets	Weeks 1–2, Google Sheets only	Weeks 1–2, Sheets or Excel; cleaning (TRIM, duplicates) in Week 1, lookups/XLOOKUP in Week 2
SQL	Weeks 3–4 (SELECT to JOIN and subqueries)	Weeks 3–4, plus Kaggle Intro to SQL	Weeks 3–5, deepest coverage: JOINs, CTEs, CASE WHEN, CSV export
Python and Pandas	Python Wk 5, Pandas Wk 6, cleaning Wk 7	Python Wk 5, Pandas Wk 6, cleaning Wk 7	Python Wk 8, Pandas Wk 9, EDA Wk 10
Statistics	Week 8 (after Pandas)	Week 8 (after cleaning)	Week 6 (before Python)
Visualization	Week 9: Matplotlib and Seaborn	Week 9: Kaggle Data Viz, optional Tableau Public	Week 7: Tableau Public; Seaborn/Matplotlib in Week 10
Dashboarding	Dedicated Week 10: Power BI (Windows) or spreadsheet dashboard	None dedicated (optional Tableau Public)	Week 7: interactive Tableau or Power BI dashboard
Portfolio phase	Weeks 11–12	Weeks 10–12 (three weeks)	Weeks 11–12
Portfolio project	Specific: Retail Sales Analysis Dashboard	Open: learner picks dataset and writes problem statement	Open: public dataset (Kaggle, data.gov)
Final deliverables	README, cleaned data, code, SQL, dashboard, findings, limitations, 3–5 min presentation	Public GitHub repo, README, documented notebook, peer review	Public GitHub link, Tableau dashboard link, README
Main resources	Microsoft Excel Help, SQLBolt, Kaggle Learn, pandas docs, Khan Academy, Matplotlib/Seaborn docs, Microsoft Learn (Power BI)	Google Sheets Help, SQLBolt, Kaggle Learn and Datasets, pandas docs, Khan Academy, GitHub	Kaggle Learn, SQLBolt, freeCodeCamp, Coursera (audit), Mode SQL, GCF, Khan Academy, Tableau
Cost transparency	Short 'Free resources and cost notes' section (Excel licence caveat)	Every resource tagged Free / Free (verify) / Paid; flags unverified items	Pricing table (e.g. Coursera free audit vs paid certificate)
Completion criteria	Combined into one exercise/criterion column	Separate exercise and measurable criterion columns	Separate measurable completion criterion column
Skills summary	Bullet list of 4 groups	Bullet list of 8 items plus 'Items to verify yourself'	5 numbered categories with sub-bullets
Formatting quality	Clean, readable	Clean, readable	Weekly table garbled in the PDF; words split across cells

Key Takeaways

- **A and B are nearly identical in structure** (Sheets, SQL, Python, Pandas, cleaning, stats, viz). A adds a Power BI dashboard week and a fixed project; B adds GitHub publishing and peer review.
- **C is the outlier.** It teaches statistics and Tableau before Python and gives SQL three weeks (CTEs, CASE WHEN). It has the weakest layout and no cleaning week in Python.

- **Most honest about resources:** B, which labels what was and was not verified. C leans on Coursera audit and Tableau, which may have access limits.
- **Best for a guided portfolio:** A, with a defined project and presentation. B suits learners who want to choose their own topic.
- **Best for deeper SQL:** C.
- **Suggested hybrid:** B's cost tags and GitHub/peer-review step, A's dashboard week and project brief, and C's CTE and CASE WHEN SQL content.